DAILY QUIZ · 12 NOVEMBER 2026 · 12 MIN READ

Travelling with your bike: bags, packing and events

Customers who race Ironman, ride brevets in other cities or travel abroad for events have to get the bike there in one piece. A travel bag is a high-value sale, and wrong advice here can mean a cracked frame on race morning. Read this carefully.

1. Ways to travel with a bike

- **Flight**: the bike goes as checked baggage in a bike bag or case. This is where proper protection matters most, because baggage is stacked and thrown.
- **Train**: the bike is booked as luggage or parcel and travels in the luggage van. It needs a cover at minimum, and a padded bag is better.
- **Bus**: goes in the hold. Use at least a carry bag so the bike is one clean package.
- **Car**: on a rack, or inside with the wheels off in a carry bag to keep the car and the bike clean.

2. Types of bike bag

TYPE	PROTECTION	WEIGHT	GOOD AND BAD
Carry bag (tarpaulin)	Scratches and dirt only. No padding.	About 1.4 kg	For car, bus, train and metro. Not for airline check-in.
Padded soft bag with internal frame	Good. The bike is bolted to a frame inside, with padding around it.	8 to 12 kg	Least dismantling. Folds flat for storage. The most popular choice for events.
Semi-rigid EVA case	Better against crushing. Moulded shell about 1 cm thick.	8 to 10 kg	More dismantling: handlebar usually comes off. Does not fold.
Hard case	The most. Rigid shell.	15 kg and more	Heaviest and most expensive. Eats into the airline weight allowance.

3. What we sell

BAG	TYPE	WHAT TO KNOW	PRICE
Scicon Aerocomfort 3.0 Road	Padded soft, internal frame	Only the wheels come off. Handlebar, saddle and seatpost stay on, so the bike fit is not lost. Built-in stand, quick release and thru-axle adapters in the box, eight 360° wheels, TSA padlock. Disc and rim brake bikes. Folds.	₹72,000
Scicon Aerocomfort 3.0 Triathlon	Padded soft, internal frame	For tri and TT bikes. No removal of handlebars, saddle, seatpost or pedals. Comes with an aerobar protector. 11.5 kg, 130 cm wide.	₹72,000

XXF N1808	Padded soft, internal frame	TT and road bikes. No handlebar removal. 1680D nylon, auto-inflating side pads, four wheels. 9.8 kg.	₹59,900
XXF N1602	Padded soft, internal frame	Road bikes fit without removing the bar. **Thru-axle bikes only, not quick release.**	₹57,900
XXF N1603	Padded soft	MTB and road. Handlebar, pedals and wheels come off. 900D nylon, 7.8 kg, two wheels.	₹32,900
XXF E1702	EVA case	Road, TT and MTB up to 29 inch (size L). **Fits bikes with an integrated seatpost.** 118 × 28 × 96 cm, 9.8 kg, TSA lock.	₹39,900
XXF E0901	EVA case	Road and MTB up to 27.5 inch. **Does not fit 29ers or integrated seatpost bikes.** 8.3 kg.	₹32,900
RideNow Aluminium Alloy Travel Case	Hard case	Road, gravel, TT and cyclocross. Remove the wheels and seatpost and turn the handlebars. Suits fully integrated cockpits. Built-in TSA locks. 136 × 36 × 75 cm, **16.8 kg empty**.	₹1,25,900
XXF PE012	Tarpaulin carry bag	Two compartments keep frame and wheels apart. 1.35 kg, folds small. Car, bus, train, metro.	₹5,350
XXF W1608	Double wheel bag	Padded, with a board that protects the cassette. For a second wheelset.	₹4,490

Prices are our website listings on 12 November 2026. Check the site before you quote.

RideNow also makes the TPU tubes and tubeless parts we stock. A TPU tube weighs about 36 g and packs tiny, so it is the ideal spare for a travelling rider.

Scicon protection extras we list: rear derailleur protector hood, handlebar shield, rear triangle frame shield, fork protection pad, top tube pad and aerobar protector.

4. Choosing the right bag: the questions

- **Which bike?** Road, TT or MTB, and what wheel size.
- **Which axles?** Quick release or thru-axle. The XXF N1602 takes thru-axle bikes only.
- **What cockpit and seatpost?** A fully integrated cockpit is slow and risky to dismantle, so choose a bag that leaves the bar on. An integrated seatpost cannot be removed, so the bag must be tall enough: the XXF E1702 fits, the E0901 does not.
- **How will you travel, and how often?** One flight a year is different from six.
- **Can you rebuild the bike yourself?** If not, sell the bag that needs the least dismantling.
- **What is the airline's limit?** See below.

5. The weight sum

Airlines set a weight limit per checked piece, and many charge a separate sports equipment fee. Limits and fees differ by airline and route, so tell the customer to read the airline's sports equipment policy **before booking the ticket**, and where required, to pre-book the bike.

Always do the sum with the customer: **bag weight + bike weight + everything else packed inside**. Example with a 23 kg limit and a 9 kg triathlon bike:

- Scicon Aerocomfort Triathlon: 11.5 + 9 = 20.5 kg. About 2.5 kg left for shoes and helmet.
- RideNow aluminium case: 16.8 + 9 = 25.8 kg. Over the limit before anything else goes in.

The hard case protects the most, but it only makes sense when the allowance covers it.

6. Packing the bike for a flight

- **Clean the bike.** Some countries inspect bikes for soil.
- **Photograph it** from both sides before packing, and again inside the open bag. This is the proof for any damage claim.
- **Mark the fit.** Put tape on the seatpost at the clamp, and note saddle height and bar position.
- **Shift to the smallest cog** so the rear derailleur sits inboard.
- **Remove the pedals** if the bag needs it. The left pedal has a reverse thread: it loosens clockwise.
- **Remove the wheels.** Take out the thru-axles and put them back into the bag's frame mounts or tape them inside the bag.
- **Fit pad spacers into the disc calipers.** Without them, a squeezed brake lever closes the pistons and the wheel will not go back in.
- **Protect the rotors.** Keep them away from the frame, or remove them if the bag presses on them. A bent rotor rubs.
- **Protect the rear derailleur.** It is the most commonly damaged part. Use a derailleur guard, or unbolt the derailleur from its hanger, wrap it and tie it inside the rear triangle. Pack a spare derailleur hanger.
- **Let some air out of the tyres, not all of it.** A soft tyre still protects the rim. A fully flat tubeless tyre can unseat and lose its sealant.
- **Fit the dropout spacers** or the bag's axle adapters so the fork and rear triangle cannot be crushed.
- **Pad every contact point.** Top tube, fork legs, chainstays and shifters.
- **Nothing loose inside.** A loose tool or pump will chip paint and carbon for the whole journey.

7. Batteries, CO2 and tools

- **SRAM AXS**: remove the batteries from both derailleurs, fit the battery blocks, and carry the batteries in cabin baggage.
- **Shimano Di2**: the battery is inside the frame and stays there. Make sure the system cannot be woken by pressed buttons in transit, and carry the charger.
- **Lights and computers**: lithium batteries and power banks go in cabin baggage, not in the bike bag.
- **CO2 cartridges**: many airlines do not allow them, or need approval. Advise a mini pump and buying CO2 at the destination.
- **Pack the tools needed to rebuild**: hex keys, a torque wrench for carbon parts, pedal spanner, chain lube, tape.

8. Specific to events

- **Arrive at least two days before the race.** If the bag is delayed or a part is damaged, there is time to fix it.
- **Carry the race-critical items in cabin baggage**: helmet, cycling shoes, pedals, race kit and the bike computer. A bike can be borrowed. Your own shoes and pedals cannot.
- **Rebuild and test ride on arrival**, not on race morning. Check every bolt with a torque wrench, check the gears and brakes, and ride for ten minutes.
- **Pack spares**: derailleur hanger, tubes, a tyre, a chain quick link, brake pads.
- **Put a tracker tag inside the bag** and a name card with a phone number.
- **Book a pre-travel service** about a week ahead, and offer to pack the bike in the store if the customer has never done it.

9. What to sell with the bag

Derailleur guard and frame pads, a spare hanger, TPU tubes, a mini pump, a torque wrench, pad spacers, a wheel bag for a second wheelset, and the pre-travel service.

Remember these

- Carry bag for car, bus and train. Padded bag with internal frame, EVA case or hard case for flights.
- Scicon Aerocomfort: only wheels off. XXF N1602: thru-axle only. XXF E1702 fits integrated seatposts, E0901 does not. RideNow hard case: 16.8 kg empty.
- Do the weight sum: bag + bike + contents against the airline limit.
- Pad spacers in, derailleur protected, some air out, nothing loose, photos before packing.
- Events: arrive two days early, shoes, pedals and helmet in cabin baggage, rebuild and test ride on arrival.